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Education

- 2027 PhD in Economics, IIES, Stockholm University (expected June 2027)
 - Advisors: [Torsten Persson](#) (main) & [David Schönholzer](#)
- 2024/25 Recognised Student, University of Oxford, hosted by [Noam Yuchtman](#)
- 2018 MSc in Econometrics, Stockholm University
 - GPA 5.0/5.0
- 2016 BA in Philosophy, Stockholm University
- 2015 BSc & MSc in Mathematics, Stockholm University
 - Mittag-Leffler Institute Award for Excellent MSc Thesis

References

David Strömberg Stockholm University, NEK ✉ david.stromberg@su.se	Torsten Persson Stockholm University, IIES ✉ torsten.persson@iies.su.se	David Schönholzer University of Southern California, Economics ✉ dschonho@usc.edu
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Research Fields

Economic History, Political Economy, Economic Development

Job Market Paper

Coffeehouses and the Rise of Science (with [Jens Oehlen](#))

Can social spaces raise knowledge production by lowering the cost of learning from others? Historians have long credited coffeehouses, commercial venues where strangers met across social ranks, with fostering rational debate and seeding Enlightenment culture. We test this claim for science in seventeenth-century London. Using geocoded records and a staggered event study across parishes, we find a substantial and lasting increase in the number of mathematical practitioners and scientific instrument shops following a parish's first coffeehouse. Effects are concentrated among practitioners with weak ties to Oxford and Cambridge, connections between theory-oriented scientists and instrument makers multiply, and new shops turn toward experimental instruments. We argue coffeehouses fostered this growth by cheapening access to scientific knowledge for those outside academic networks and by making experimental science interactive and public.

Working Papers

Learning to Participate: The Effects of the First Female Teachers (with [Mattias Folkestad](#))

How does opening a profession to a previously excluded group shape the next generation? From 1859, Sweden allowed women to hold teaching posts in elementary schools. We digitize teacher registers, district maps, and 350,000 signatures from the 1913–14 suffrage petition, linked to full-count censuses. Event studies exploiting the staggered timing of districts' first female hire show that women exposed as schoolgirls were 23 percent more likely to sign the petition and, in 1910, 9 percent more likely to work outside the home. Using the presence of women's teacher seminaries nearby as an instrument, we find more suffrage associations and higher female turnout.

Wealth Confiscation and Elite Persistence: Evidence from the Great Reduction (with [Jonatan Riberth](#))

This paper studies how far a wealth shock persists across generations and erodes status by examining the largest confiscation in Swedish history: the Great Reduction of 1680, which took half the nobility's landed wealth. Linking noble genealogies to manor ownership across the Swedish realm, we compare descendants of nobles who lost manors with those of observably similar nobles who did not. Manor ownership falls sharply and stays lower four generations later, by more than mobility correlations predict. Yet careers, marriages, human capital, and demographic outcomes barely move, though they respond strongly to membership in the political elite.

Work in Progress

Governing the Hajj: Colonial Mobility and Islamic Organization in the Dutch East Indies

Other Writing

Lärarinnorna som banade väg för kvinnors frigörelse (with [Mattias Folkestad](#)), *Ekonomisk Debatt* 53 (3): 22–28, 2025

De utmanade den manliga statsmaktens legitimitet, *Liberal Debatt* 2023 (6), 2023

Weather and Conflicts in Afghanistan, *Expert Group for Aid Studies, Sweden*, EBA Working Paper, June, 2018

Bör mainstreamekonomin reformeras?, *Ekonomisk Debatt* 45 (3): 70–74, 2017

Grants and Scholarships

2025	Research grant, Lars Hierta Memorial Foundation, 30,000 SEK ($\approx$ €2,700)
2021–24	Research grants, Carl Mannerfelt Foundation, 153,400 SEK ($\approx$ €14,000)
2021	PhD exchange scholarship, Tom Hedelius Foundation, 499,000 SEK ($\approx$ €45,000)
2021	Research grant, Karl Staaff Foundation, 75,000 SEK ($\approx$ €7,000)
2019	PhD scholarship, Erik Johan Ljungberg Foundation, 125,000 SEK ($\approx$ €11,000)

Presentations

2026	EAYE Annual Meeting, University of the Basque Country; Economic Inequality and Political Institutions in the Nordic and Baltic Regions, c. 1400–1900, Uppsala University (co-author, scheduled); IIES, Stockholm University; RIDGE Forum, University of the West Indies (co-author); SIOE Conference, INSEAD Fontainebleau; TSE; University of Gothenburg (co-author); Uppsala Workshop in Economic History; Workshop on Growth, History and Development, University of Southern Denmark; Workshop on Wealth Inequality, Intergenerational Mobility, and Equality of Opportunity, WU Wien (co-author, scheduled); Yale-UB HPE Workshop, University of Barcelona; Zurich Workshop in AI & Applied Economics (co-author, scheduled)
2025	Danish HPE Workshop, University of Southern Denmark (co-author); IIES, Stockholm University; SUDSWEC, Stockholm School of Economics
2024	Arthur Lewis Lab, University of Manchester (co-author); New Perspectives on Swedish Political History, Stockholm University; SUDSWEC, Stockholm University (co-author); Summer 2024 IOG-BFI Conference; Swedish Conference in Economics, Lund University (co-author); University of Oxford
2023	ASWEDE Conference; Harvard University PE Tea (co-author); Institute of Urban History, Stockholm University; SUDSWEC, Uppsala University; Swedish Register-Based Research Summit
2021	Stockholm University
2018	Expert Group for Aid Studies, Sweden

Research Assistantships

2018/19 Research Assistant for **David Seim** & **David Strömberg**, Stockholm University
 2018 Research Assistant at the Expert Group for Aid Studies, Sweden
 2017 Research Assistant for **Nils Karlson**, Ratio Institute, Stockholm

Teaching Assistantships

2022 Econometrics II (PhD), Stockholm Doctoral Program in Economics
 2019–22 Mathematics II (PhD), Stockholm Doctoral Program in Economics
 2019 Empirical Methods in Economics 3 (BSc), Stockholm University
 2018/19 Econometrics 3b: Time Series Analysis (MSc), Stockholm University
 2017–19 Econometrics I (MSc), Stockholm University
 2015–19 10+ BSc Mathematics & Statistics courses, Stockholm University, KTH, & MHS Karlberg

Academic Service

2021–23 Organiser, Applied Econometrics Reading Group, IIES, Stockholm University
 2015/16 Vice President, Council of the Faculty of Arts, Stockholm University
 2015/16 Student Representative, Board of the Faculty of Arts, Stockholm University

Software

Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS, QGIS, MATLAB, Mathematica, SPARQL, Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Personal Information

Citizenship: Swedish

Languages: Swedish (first language), English (fluent), Moroccan Arabic (basic)

Career Breaks

2025–26 Parental leave (7 months)
 2022–23 Parental leave (8 months)